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CB23F35: Low-Code Application Development using Zoho Creator

EX. 11: Portal User Management in Zoho Creator

1. AIM

To configure portal user access in Zoho Creator by inviting external users to an application, guiding them through sign-up, assigning suitable permissions, and managing their portal accounts.

2. THEORY

A portal in Zoho Creator provides an external access point through which people outside an organization can use selected application features. Instead of adding every external person as an internal organization user, an administrator can invite them as portal users. Portal users sign in with their own credentials and can access only the forms, reports, pages, and actions permitted by their assigned permissions.

Important elements of portal user management include:

- **Invitation:** An administrator enters the user's name and email address and sends an invitation to join the portal.
- **Account activation:** The invited person follows the invitation link, creates a password, and completes the sign-up process.
- **User status:** A user who has completed sign-up may appear as approved, while an invitation that has not been accepted may remain unconfirmed.
- **Permissions:** Permission settings determine which application components and actions a portal user is allowed to access.
- **Account maintenance:** Administrators can manage permitted user details, update access permissions, and remove portal access when it is no longer needed.
- **Security:** Access should follow the principle of least privilege, giving each user only the permissions required for their role.

3. PROCEDURE

- Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the Portal section from the Deploy area.
- Select the application for which portal access is required and open its Portal User section.
- Choose Add Portal Users and enter the invited user's name and email address.
- Assign an appropriate permission profile, such as Customer, and send the invitation.
- Open the invitation email and follow the provided link to create a portal password.
- Enter and confirm a password that satisfies the password requirements shown by the portal.
- Sign in through the portal and verify that the permitted application pages and forms are accessible.
- Return to the Portal User list and check the user's current status and assigned permission.
- Invite another test user if required, and observe how the user count changes.
- Use the status filter to view approved or unconfirmed users.
- Open the user options to review available account-management actions, such as editing permitted details or changing permissions.
- Return to the main Portal page and verify that the application and its portal-user count are displayed.

4. PORTAL USER STATUS

Status	Meaning	Administrator action
Unconfirmed	The invitation has been sent, but the user has not completed the sign-up process.	Check the invitation status and follow up if necessary.
Approved	The user has completed the required sign-up and is registered for portal access.	Review the assigned permission and ensure access remains appropriate.

5. PERMISSIONS AND ACCESS CONTROL

Portal permissions are used to control the features available to each external user. For example, a Customer permission may allow a user to submit an appointment request and view permitted information, while an Admin-level permission may provide broader management capabilities if configured by the application owner. The actual access granted depends on the permission settings applied to the application.

Role example	Possible access
Customer / External User	Submit permitted forms and view their allowed records or pages.
Administrator	Manage portal users and access broader application functions, subject to configuration.

6. APPLICATION

In a clinic management application, portal access can be provided to external patients or customers who need to interact with selected services. An invited user could sign in and submit an appointment request through the Appointment Scheduling form. The administrator can manage invitations and assign the permission profile that determines which application features the user can access. This allows external users to use the application without being added as internal organization users.

7. ADVANTAGES OF PORTAL USER MANAGEMENT

- Provides controlled access to selected application features for people outside the organization.
- Keeps external users separate from internal organization users.
- Supports individual user accounts and permission-based access.
- Allows administrators to monitor invitation status and manage accounts.
- Can improve coordination with customers, patients, vendors, and other external participants.

8. OUTPUT

The expected output is a portal configured for the selected application, with invited users listed under their current status and assigned permission. Evidence may include the invitation email, password creation page, portal login, Portal User list, status filter, permission options, and the application entry on the Portal page. Add screenshots from your own Zoho Creator setup to demonstrate the actual configuration.

9. RESULT

Thus, portal user management in Zoho Creator was studied and documented. The process covers inviting external users, completing sign-up, checking user status, assigning permissions, and managing portal accounts to provide controlled access to an application.